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School of Health and Rehabilitation Sciences

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RE: Recommendation Letter in Support of Farnaz Rezvani Application for PhD Program

Dear Admission Committee,

It gives me great pleasure to provide this recommendation letter to express my strong support for Farnaz Rezvani application for admission to your PhD program.

I am Ahmad P. Tafti, and I am an Assistant Professor of Health Informatics in the Department of Health Information Management within the School of Health and Rehabilitation Sciences at the University of Pittsburgh, with a secondary appointment in the Intelligent Systems Program (ISP) at the School of Computing and Information. I am leading the Pitt HexAI Research Laboratory, also serving as the Director of Scientific Affairs at Computational Pathology & AI Center of Excellence (CPACE). Furthermore, I am a Fellow of the American Medical Informatics Association (AMIA). Moreover, I am honored to serve our community as the Vice Chair of the IEEE Computer Society in Pittsburgh. I have a deep passion for AI-Powered healthcare informatics and health data science with better patient diagnosis, prognosis, and treatment using large-scale multiple clinical data sources and advanced computational algorithms.

I got to know Farnaz Rezvani since she started working with me as a graduate research assistant in my Pitt HexAI Research Laboratory in late 2024. After four months and based on her endless support and engagement in our research projects, we had her lead our GitHub repository initiatives and software development. Farnaz has been a key participant in our research laboratory, working on several interesting projects ranging from explainable AI in predictive models to trustworthy AI in medical imaging informatics. She is also providing mentorship services to junior researchers and undergraduate students in our lab.

With that, Farnaz has been actively involved in building, training, and evaluating AI models to tackle different real-world clinical problems. Our seamless collaborations with Farnaz resulted in several manuscripts in reputable conferences (e.g., AMIA and ISBI) and prestigious journals (e.g., npj Health Systems – under revision), for example:

[1] **Rezvani F**, Towsen K, Menezes Z, Einhorn A, Davis J, Gupta P, Plate JF, Fox C, Myers N, Tafti AP. Trustworthy and Uncertainty-Aware AI for Predicting Respiratory Complications Following Total Hip and Knee Arthroplasty. In AMIA Annual Symposium Proceedings 2025 May 22 (Vol. 2024, p. 1089). URL: https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12919624

[2] **Rezvani F**, Jain V, Gao F, Littlefield N, Kann M, Plate JF, Tafti AP. Prompt-constrained vision-language models for zero-shot orthopedic pathology recognition. In: Proceedings of the International Symposium on Biomedical Imaging (ISBI); 2026. [Abstract]

[3] **Rezvani F**, Han Y, Kann M, Littlefield N, Maradit Kremers H, Yates AJ, Plate JF, Tafti AP. Uncertainty-quantified and explainable age- and sex-aware contrastive learning for knee osteoarthritis classification. In: Proceedings of the International Symposium on Biomedical Imaging (ISBI); 2026. URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=sPeP6WPeJT

[4] **Rezvani F**, Kann M, Gao F, Gupta P, Myers N, Kashefi A, et al. Trustworthy AI models to predict prolonged hospital length-of-stay in orthopedic surgery. npj Health Systems. [Under Re-submission]

In all these research projects, Farnaz's collaboration exceeded my expectations for both research activities and innovative ideas, and we still have a list of manuscripts coming up for submission. I have always considered Farnaz as a great asset to our Pitt HexAI Research Laboratory.

Farnaz Rezvani has been quite active. She has been an excellent resource for us. To me, Farnaz is a highly respected graduate student focusing on AI-powered health informatics and life science applications. We are grateful to have Farnaz with us, and I believe this is an excellent opportunity for our Pitt HexAI Research Laboratory. Working closely with Farnaz Rezvani is an exceptional experience. Her role as our research assistant and project lead throughout the projects showcased her remarkable commitment and expertise in health informatics and meaningful teamwork. Her always approachable demeanor and effective communication made our collaborations both productive and enjoyable. To me, with her profound contribution, Farnaz stands as a highly knowledgeable, respectful student, and talented young investigator to your fellowship program, particularly with its focus on health informatics to enhance healthcare.

In summary, I have found Farnaz Rezvani a hard-working, smart, and knowledgeable research individual who has kept enriching her knowledge and expertise in his field of study, including AI and health data sciences. I recognize the importance of Farnaz's participation in the health data science community, and I will strongly support and promote her professional development.

Please do not hesitate to contact me if you would like more information about Farnaz.

Sincerely,

Ahmad P. Tafti, PhD, FAMIA

Ahmad P. Tafti

04/18/2026

University of Pittsburgh

ORACLE Eureka Award 2023 Recipient

SIIM Imaging Informatics Innovator Award 2021 Recipient

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